

Ray Kurzweil's Linear Chart from "The Singularity is Near"

Paradigm Shifts Timeline - Evolution is Speeding Up

Acceleration Theory

15 Billion Years Ago

Universe begins, matter and energy emerge

4.6 Billion Years Ago

Sun and planets form, Earth solidifies

4 Billion Years Ago

First single-celled organisms emerge

1.9 Billion Years Ago

Eukaryotes with nuclei develop

1 Billion Years Ago

Complex organisms with specialized cells

570 Million Years Ago

Rapid diversification of life forms

490 Million Years Ago

Fish and early backbone animals

210 Million Years Ago

Warm-blooded creatures emerge

60 Million Years Ago

Early ancestors of humans and apes

2.6 Million Years Ago

Homo species emerge in Africa

1.7 Million Years Ago

First systematic tool use

410,000 Years Ago

Mastery of fire by early humans

19,000 Years Ago

Farming and permanent settlements

6,300 Years Ago

First written language systems

500 Years Ago

Systematic observation and experiment

200 Years Ago

Steam power and mass production

100 Years Ago

Computers and digital technology

2045 (Predicted)

Artificial intelligence surpasses human intelligence

15 Billion Years Ago Billions Millions Thousands Present → Future

